

CASE STUDY · PARTNERSHIP

Alameda Health System and Royal Partner to Streamline Patient Transportation

Early results point to an 81% reduction in unauthorized transport costs following the launch of the Centralized Transportation Hub.

PARTNERSHIP

17+ Years

INITIATIVE

CTH Pilot, 2024

CURRENT PHASE

Phase II Active

81%

Reduction in Unauthorized
Transport Charges

John George Psychiatric Hospital ·
Phase II

AMBULATORY COST REDUCTION

92%

Avg. weekly spend · Phase I

POST-ACUTE COST REDUCTION

98%

Avg. weekly spend · Phase I

RIDESHARE COST REDUCTION

58%

Non-medical transport · Phase I

The Situation

Royal and Alameda Health System have a longstanding partnership spanning over 17 years. For certain patients, AHS depends on a third-party transportation provider for authorization and order routing.

When the third-party gave long ETAs, departments often skipped the authorization process and called Royal directly. Royal grew concerned that AHS was taking on unnecessary costs by bypassing that step. Variation in authorization across departments also created bottlenecks that slowed patient movement.

Authorization Gaps

Long third-party ETAs pushed departments to skip the authorization process and call Royal directly, creating unnecessary cost exposure for AHS.

Workflow Inconsistency

Variation in authorization steps across departments created bottlenecks, slowed patient movement, and led to over- and under-utilization of different transport types.

The Solution

In 2024, AHS and Royal Ambulance co-created the Centralized Transportation Hub (CTH) pilot to streamline how patient transportation is ordered and managed across care settings, improving patient flow while creating more efficient internal workflows for staff.

The primary change: instead of department staff calling providers directly, requests now route through the CTH. Hub staff coordinate transportation, confirm preauthorization, and validate the appropriate level of service at the point of request.

1 Confirm preauthorization at the start instead of later



2 Validate level of service before dispatch

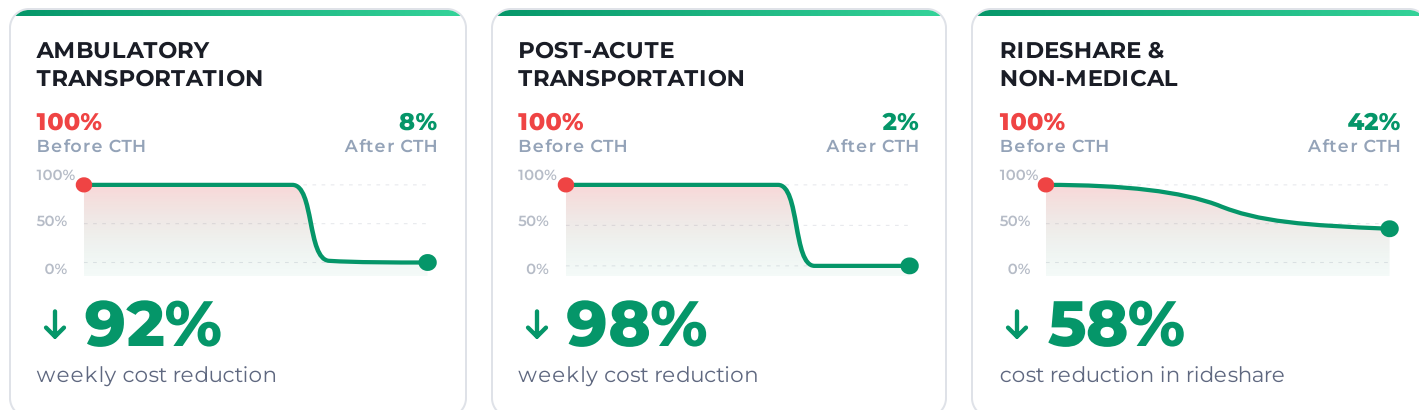


3 Route every request through the same consistent steps

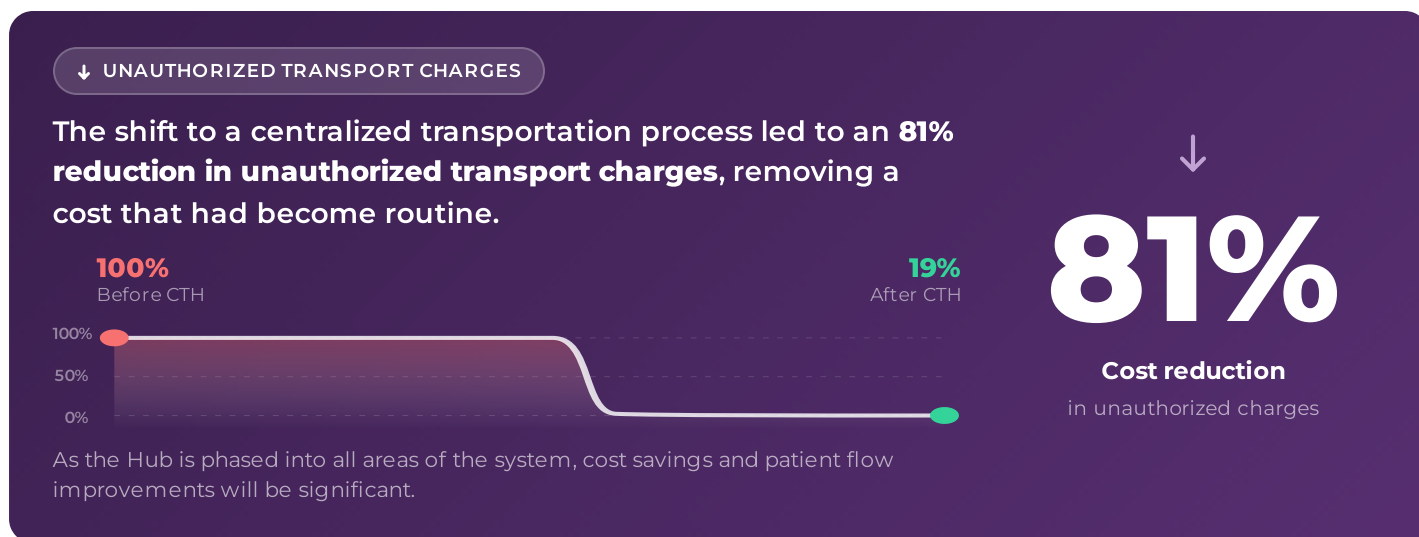


The Results

PHASE I • AVERAGE WEEKLY COST REDUCTION



PHASE II SPOTLIGHT • JOHN GEORGE PSYCHIATRIC HOSPITAL



"Delays and no-authorization transports had become a regular challenge for our teams. We partnered with Royal to centralize and standardize the workflow so authorization occurred before dispatch, allowing us to reduce delays, avoid unnecessary costs, and move patients more efficiently."

DL

Dana Littlepage

Alameda Health System

Looking Ahead

✓ PHASE I • COMPLETE

Initial CTH Pilot Launch

Established the Centralized Transportation Hub, standardized the intake process, and validated the model across initial care settings, delivering significant cost reductions across ambulatory, post-acute, and non-medical transport.

➔ PHASE II • IN PROGRESS

System-Wide Rollout

The Hub is being phased into all areas of AHS. Results at John George Psychiatric Hospital, an 81% reduction in unauthorized transport charges, demonstrate the model's scalability. Cost savings and patient flow improvements are expected to grow as the rollout continues.